To get a C (75):

Data
What this data represents: Invented average daily recreational screen time (phones, social media, streaming, excluding schoolwork) and cumulative GPA for students across 12 university majors.

Misleading Narrative

A comprehensive new survey of undergraduate students across twelve academic programs has uncovered a disturbing and consistent pattern: the more time a student spends on their phone and streaming services, the worse their academic performance. The findings, which tracked average daily recreational screen time alongside cumulative GPA, paint an alarming picture for university administrators and parents alike.

At the top of the academic ladder sit Nursing students, who report just 4.2 hours of daily recreational screen time and maintain a strong average GPA of 3.41. At the bottom? Art & Design students, who average a staggering 8.1 hours of daily screen use and post a dismal GPA of just 2.65. That is a difference of nearly a full GPA point, enough to mean the difference between graduating with honors and struggling to find employment.

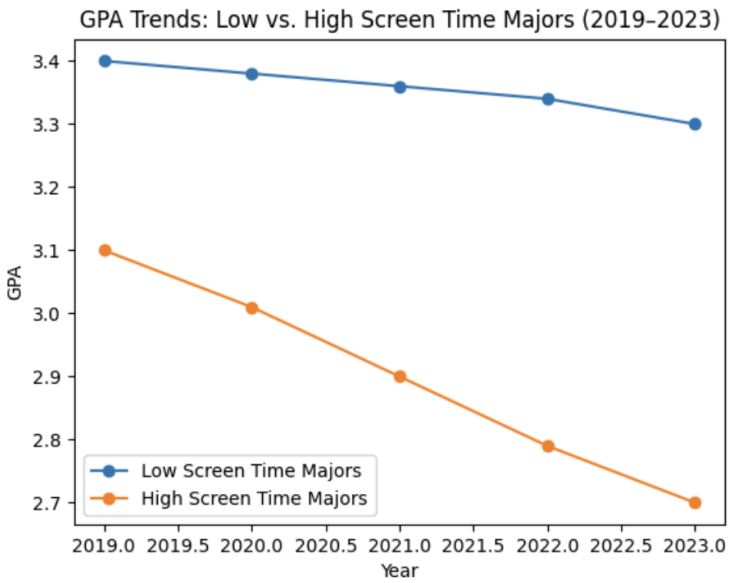
The pattern holds almost perfectly across every major examined. Computer Science students clock nearly 7.8 hours of screen time daily and earn only a 2.81 GPA. Communications students are close behind at 7.9 hours and a 2.72 GPA. Even Engineering students, traditionally among the most disciplined, show signs of screen-time damage at 6.9 hours and a 2.98 GPA.

Contrast these figures with Education majors, who average just 5.1 hours of screen time and maintain a 3.35 GPA, or Biology students at 5.7 hours and a 3.28 GPA. The message is clear: majors that attract more disciplined, screen-conscious students consistently outperform those with higher device dependency.

Researchers are calling for universities to implement mandatory "digital curfews" in dormitories after 10pm, restrict social media access on campus WiFi networks, and embed digital wellness training into first-year orientation programs. Without intervention, they warn, an entire generation of students risks graduating with GPAs that permanently close doors to graduate school and competitive careers.

The charts below, generated with AI assistance, illustrate just how severe and consistent this relationship is across the academic landscape. The trend line tells a story that university leadership can no longer afford to ignore.

Fig. 1 - This chart shows a strong negative relationship between screen time and GPA across majors, reinforced by a downward trend line.



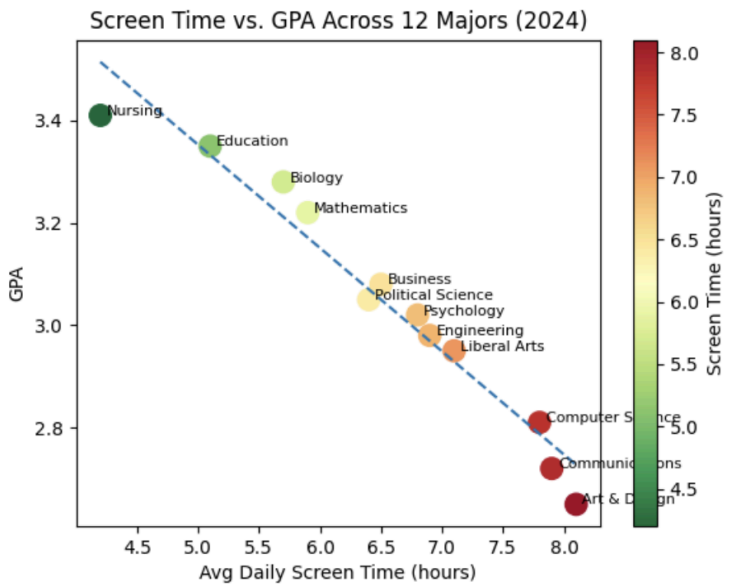


Fig. 2 - GPA trends diverge over time, with high screen-time majors experiencing a steeper decline.